

Chirag Yadav

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Professional Profile

Applied economist with five years of full-time experience conducting and managing economic and policy research for government and private-sector clients, complemented by doctoral training in applied microeconomics and causal inference. Experienced in leading research teams, developing empirical methodologies, and translating quantitative analysis into policy-facing reports and presentations.

Professional Experience

Institute for Competitiveness

Research Manager

Gurgaon, India

Jul 2020 – Jun 2021

- Led and managed teams of 10+ researchers on economic, policy, and strategy engagements for government and private-sector clients; oversaw project planning, task allocation, analytical quality control, and timely delivery.
- Designed and delivered data and methodology workshops for 40+ officials from India's Ministry of Housing and NITI Aayog, translating quantitative methods and research findings for government and policy audiences.
- **Ease of Living Index 2020:** Collaborated with city data officers across 111 Indian cities to develop India's official data portal covering 400+ livability indicators and helped develop the methodology and estimation procedures used to compare cities and municipalities.
- Contributed to research projects spanning urban, industrial, and social policy, working across survey design, methodology development, data analysis, and client-facing research delivery.

Data Analyst

Aug 2016 – Jun 2020

- Automated extraction and processing of data from databases and web-based sources using Python scripts and Excel workflows, reducing data-processing time by approximately 10 hours per person per project.
- Adapted empirical research methodologies to client-specific economic and policy questions while maintaining analytical rigor and data accuracy.
- Contributed to policy reports, methodology documents, quantitative analyses, and client-facing research deliverables for public- and private-sector engagements.

Education

University of Illinois Chicago

PhD, Applied Economics; GPA: 3.84/4.00

Chicago, IL

Expected May 2027

Fields: Labor Economics, Economics of Education, Applied Microeconomics.

South Asian University

MA, Economics

New Delhi, India

May 2016

University of Delhi

BA (Hons.), Economics

New Delhi, India

July 2014

Technical Skills

Methods: Econometrics, causal inference, regression discontinuity, panel-data analysis, statistical modeling, data analytics, data visualization.

Software: Stata, R, SQL, Tableau, Excel; Python (working knowledge).

Selected Applied Research

Do Accountability Ratings Reduce Information Frictions for LEP Students? *Job Market Paper*

- Examine how publicly reported school-quality ratings affect enrollment decisions and whether language-access barriers limit families’ ability to respond to public information.
- Combine restricted-use Texas administrative student records, school-accountability data, and a hand-collected measure of Spanish-language television access.
- Find limited enrollment response among Hispanic LEP families to ratings alone, with heterogeneous responses associated with access to Spanish-language information.

Family Responses to School Accountability Ratings *Working Paper*
with Gregory Phelan, Javaeria Qureshi and Steve Rivkin

- Use a regression discontinuity design around Texas accountability-rating thresholds to estimate how school-quality information affects enrollment and student mobility.
- Find that higher ratings increase enrollment primarily through incoming transfers and new entrants, with stronger responses when ratings are more informative about families’ own student groups.

Unions & Market Power: Evidence from Right-to-Work Laws *Ongoing Research*

- Combine Burning Glass job-posting data with Quarterly Workforce Indicators to study how reductions in union power interact with local labor-market concentration to affect labor-market outcomes.

Teaching & Management Experience

University of Illinois Chicago *Chicago, IL*
Course Instructor *Jul 2023 – Present*

- Teach and manage a 220-student undergraduate/graduate microeconomics course; supervise two teaching assistants and coordinate course timelines, assessments, and delivery.
- Design course content and communicate economic concepts and quantitative reasoning to audiences with varied technical backgrounds.

Teaching Assistant *Aug 2021 – May 2023*

- Led weekly discussion sections for 60+ undergraduate students over four consecutive semesters.

Selected Publications

The Age of Awakening: The Story of the Indian Economy since Independence (2019).
Co-authored with Amit Kapoor; published by Penguin India.

Innovation and Intellectual Property Rights: The Case of India (2019). Co-authored with Amit Kapoor and Manisha Kapoor; case study examining India’s intellectual-property ecosystem and innovation.

Presentations & Leadership

Mock Expert Witness, PhD Summer Symposium, Edgeworth Economics	Jun 2024
Presented a case study on the Indian economy at a Brenthurst Foundation workshop, Kenya	Jun 2023
Graduate Student Council Member, University of Illinois Chicago	2023 – 2024

Honors & Awards

Graduate Mitch Krask Award for Excellence in Undergraduate Teaching, University of Illinois Chicago	2026
Research Scholarship, Institute for Competitiveness	2021
University Medal, University of Delhi	2014